

VEDIC SCIENCE AND ITS RELEVANCE IN MODERN EDUCATION

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Abstract

The Vedas constitute an intricate aspect of the Sanskrit literature. They include all the ideas, concepts, philosophy, history, sciences, art, and literature that are present in Sanskrit literature. The Vedic science constitutes a holistic way of life; as opposed to the alien way of education, it does not incorporate in itself the intellectual, ethical, spiritual, and practical aspects. The Vedic science constitutes a unified science or system. It is a science of scientists. It is a science of sciences. The result of Vedic science lies in completing and perfecting the man, which is accomplished by education and life experiences. The objective of this paper is to discuss Vedic science and analyse the significance of Vedic science in contemporary education.

Keywords: Vedas, Education, Humanities, Arts, Holistic Development.

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INTRODUCTION

Education is one of the most significant pillars of human civilisation. The modern education system has made huge contributions to science and technology, as well as to integrating the world. However, the morals, emotional quotient and holistic growth are sidelined, and the students are made to meet the expectations of society by completing the process of education. Students are alienated from their natural surroundings and do not know themselves. Duality is created in an individual. The whole focus of the modern education system has been on materialism, while the real essence of human beings has been completely overlooked. Vedantic science is not a concept restricted to religious and ritualistic science alone. It involves philosophy, mathematics, astronomy, medicine, psychology and several other forms of science. The ancient Vedic education system did not involve just knowledge but experience, wisdom and self-realisation as well. In this write-up, I have tried to analyse the significance of Vedic science in today's education system.

HOLISTIC APPROACH TO EDUCATION

Education is one of the most crucial elements of Vedic science. The Vedic education system is centred on the physical development of the body, mind and spirit. Contrastingly, contemporary education centres on the mental development of the students. The contribution of Vedic education to education systems includes the formation of a holistic approach to education. It is concerned with various issues relating to the personal development of the students, thus creating a significant area in education. Another major contribution of the Vedic education system to the education field includes the formation of a physical, mental and spiritual education model.

EMPHASIS ON ETHICAL AND MORAL VALUES

Value-based education that carries the most value. Among the modern education systems, an absence of values like honesty is felt greatly. While technical skills might be plentiful, values such as morality and ethics have been sidelined in many cases. In the Vedas, great importance was given to the practice of honesty, non-violence, discipline and accountability. These values were not taught in isolation; they formed a significant part of daily life practices. With value-based education based on the principles of Vedic science, one can learn the skills necessary to deal with the complexities of moral issues in real life.

RELATIONSHIP BETWEEN TEACHER AND STUDENT

The Vedic model of education emphasised that there had to be a good rapport between the teacher and the learner. Education was not confined to the classroom. The relationship between the teacher and the student

The Vedic model of education emphasised that there must be rapport between the teacher and the learner. Education was not restricted to classrooms but extended to all aspects of day-to-day living.

The personalised method of teaching enabled the teacher to know his or her learners better and thus make the learning process more efficient and effective.

Modern education systems face many difficulties due to overcrowded classes and the uniformity of instruction methods. Reviving certain features of the mentor-student relationship will encourage students to participate more actively, be more motivated, and develop socially.

KNOWLEDGE AND INTEGRATION ACROSS DISCIPLINES

The field of knowledge in Vedic science is not separated into clear-cut disciplines. Instead, they consider the knowledge to be interconnected and interdependent. The study of astronomy is interlinked with mathematics and philosophy, while medicine is interlinked with ecology and spirituality.

While today's education system seems to adopt an interdisciplinary approach in the classroom, there is still an inclination to classify them into various disciplines, which makes it difficult for students to relate the knowledge they learned to real-life situations.

Utilising concepts from Vedic science allows students to acquire greater knowledge about a particular field of study, which would encourage critical and creative thinking.

MENTAL HEALTH AND AWARENESS

Student mental well-being is becoming one of the major concerns within today's schools. Conditions such as stress, anxiety, and depression are triggered by excessive academic pressure, competitiveness, and a lack of friends.

In regard to Vedic science, students will be provided with valuable methods for maintaining their psychological well-being, such as meditation, breath control exercises, and self-awareness techniques. As a result, they will manage to increase their concentration, control their emotions, and, therefore, maintain their psychological health.

The introduction of such activities in a school setting will have a positive impact on student performance and psychological well-being.

Experiential Learning

Learning through experience was the basis of Vedic education. The emphasis was placed on observation, asking questions, and applying theoretical knowledge to practice.

This approach corresponds to the contemporary ideas about active learning.

AWARENESS OF THE ENVIRONMENT AND SUSTAINABILITY

The importance of harmony between human beings and the natural world is emphasised in Vedic science. Natural objects were considered sacred, and it was believed that living in harmony with the environment was an essential aspect of life.

These values are extremely relevant in our time, when environmental issues have gained significant relevance. Educators could take advantage of Vedic ecological knowledge and make it part of their curriculum.

It would increase awareness about environmental responsibility among students by highlighting the significance of conserving natural resources.

FOCUS ON SELF-DISCOVERY AND PURPOSE

What sets Vedic education apart from other types of education is that it is self-actualising in nature. It was believed that education would help individuals know themselves better.

In contemporary times, people put more importance on how well education enables them to progress in their careers and earn money as opposed to developing into well-rounded individuals.

In order for education to contribute to the overall development of individuals, they need to be able to discover meaning and direction in their lives through education.

LANGUAGE, MEMORY, AND BRAIN DEVELOPMENT

The ancient traditions of Vedic learning emphasise oral learning, memory and speaking properly. Methods of chanting and repetition were among those methods that helped in sharpening memory and thinking skills.

Modern scientific research supports the use of similar methods as useful means for helping people with concentration, memory and the development of their brains.

Inclusion of such methods in contemporary education can be beneficial for people as they will help in developing their cognitive skills and learning more effectively.

The incorporation of Vedic science into the contemporary education system is justified, as there are several issues that arise when doing so. Some examples of challenges related to implementing this strong scientific knowledge include cultural differences, the requirement of evidence, misrepresentation and superficial implementation of Vedic science, among others. Therefore, it is necessary to explore ways in which Vedic Science can be implemented in your education system without being too rigid and considering the universal aspects of Vedic Science as well. Moreover, all educators must collaborate in formulating an education policy that is balanced.

CONCLUSION

The Vedic Sciences provide a myriad of holistic approaches to counteract the problems inherent in the current education system. Taking advantage of the teachings of Vedic Science, focusing on ethics, enhancing mental wellness, creating connections within the sciences, and facilitating learning, as well as offering teachers, learners, and policy-makers endless opportunities to construct a holistic educational experience.

Education cannot be considered just an informational conduit. Education must train learners to become individuals armed with knowledge, wisdom, empathy, and societal awareness in the rapidly evolving era fuelled by technology. Integrating the principles of Vedic Science in today's education system does not amount to replacing the existing curriculum. Rather, it enhances the current educational experience with ancient knowledge. Merging humanity's long-gone knowledge with the contemporary education system creates an education system that caters to humanity's needs at the individual, communal, societal, and spiritual levels. Constructing such an education system would ultimately ensure a cooperative and sustainable future.

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